

WEEKLY TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period:	February 20-27, 2026 (Week 4)
Report Generated:	February 27, 2026
Trader:	James
Strategies:	Cash-Secured Puts Long Calls Calendar Spreads Put Spreads
Market Environment:	Transitional Volatility - VIX declining from elevated to normal range
Account Net Liq:	\$52,207 Available: \$33,181 Buying Power: \$33,181

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: +\$435 net P&L; across 10 completed trades (60% win rate). CSP strategy broke even at -\$179 after NU and NVCR losses offset strong wins on DELL, NFLX, and CELH. The standout trade was the NFLX \$90 call calendar spread, which generated +\$937 in one day and rescued the week's P&L.; First week deploying multi-leg strategies in live trading.

Key Findings:

- CSP core strategy tested by three significant losses (NU -\$939, NVCR -\$1,334, RKL B -\$632)
- NFLX calendar spread was the week's best trade (+\$937, +79.4% return in 1 day)
- DELL CSP expired worthless for full \$987 premium capture - clean execution
- VIX declining from 20+ to 17.9 confirms the regime shift predicted in Week 1 report
- GOOGL long call positions carrying -\$57,910 unrealized loss (addressed in portfolio context section)

Strategic Assessment: The regime shift from elevated to normal volatility is underway and impacting CSP returns exactly as forecasted. The successful calendar spread execution shows strategic evolution beyond single-strategy dependence. Loss management on CSPs needs tightening: three losing CSPs totalled -\$2,905 while five winners produced +\$2,726. The discipline to diversify into calendars literally saved the week.

WEEKLY P&L; SUMMARY

Strategy	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win Rate	Gross P&L	Commissions	Net P&L
Cash-Secured Puts	8	5	3	62.5%	-\$90	\$89	-\$179
Long Calls	1	0	1	0%	-\$273	\$51	-\$324
Calendar Spread (NFLX)	1	1	0	100%	+\$940	\$3	+\$937
TOTAL COMPLETED	10	6	4	60%	+\$488	\$143	+\$435

CUMULATIVE PERFORMANCE (Feb 9-27, 2026)

Metric	Week 1 (Feb 9-19)	Week 2 (Feb 20-27)	Cumulative
Completed Trades	10	10	20
Win Rate	80.0%	60.0%	70.0%
CSP P&L	+\$1,758	-\$179	+\$1,579
Other Strategies P&L	\$0	+\$614	+\$614
Total P&L	+\$1,758	+\$435	+\$2,193
Avg P&L per Trade	+\$176	+\$44	+\$110

STRATEGY 1: CASH-SECURED PUTS

CSP WEEK-OVER-WEEK COMPARISON

Metric	Week 1 (Feb 9-19)	Week 2 (Feb 20-27)	Trend
Total CSP Trades	10	8	Fewer trades
Win Rate	80.0%	62.5%	Declining
Total P&L	+\$1,758	-\$179	Negative
Avg Return (winners)	58.7%	46.7%	Compressing
Avg Hold Time	0.7 days	1.6 days	Extending
Largest Win	\$610 (HL)	\$987 (DELL)	Improved
Largest Loss	-\$192 (NBIS)	-\$1,334 (NVCR)	Worse

Assessment: CSP P&L; went negative this week due to three losses totalling -\$2,905. The NU position (opened prior week) was the largest single-position capital exposure at \$49,500 and lost \$939. Winners still captured solid premium (24-100%), but loss management is the critical area for improvement. The regime shift is real: hold times doubled, average returns compressed, and the easy vol-crush trades are fewer.

CSP INDIVIDUAL TRADE DETAILS

#	Ticker	Entry	Exit	Days	Sell\$	Buy\$	Cts	P&L	Prem %
24	NU \$16.50P	18/02	24/02	6.0	\$0.38	\$0.68	30	-\$939	-78.9%
25	RKLB \$67P	20/02	24/02	4.0	\$1.94	\$2.98	6	-\$632	-53.6%
26	CELH \$43P	23/02	24/02	1.0	\$0.91	\$0.69	12	+\$248	+24.2%
27	CELH \$45P	23/02	24/02	1.0	\$1.44	\$1.03	7	+\$278	+28.5%
28	DELL \$114P	25/02	27/02	2.0	\$1.98	Exp.	5	+\$987	+99.7%
29	NFLX \$80P	25/02	26/02	1.0	\$1.97	\$1.13	5	+\$414	+42.6%
30	NVCR \$13P	25/02	26/02	1.0	\$0.84	\$1.78	14	-\$1,334	-111.9%
33	NFLX \$83P	26/02	27/02	1.0	\$2.51	\$0.50	4	+\$799	+80.1%

CSP TRADE NOTES

NU (-\$939): 30 contracts at \$16.50 = \$49,500 capital at risk, the largest single position this week. Opened 18/02 at \$0.38 and held 6 days through a move against. The low per-contract premium (\$0.38) meant even a small adverse move wiped out the edge. Lesson: On low-premium CSPs, contract count amplifies risk disproportionately.

RKLB (-\$632): Weekend hold on a high-beta space stock. Price moved against over 4 days. The \$1.94 entry premium was decent but not enough to absorb a \$1.04 adverse move. Lesson: Avoid weekend holds on stocks with beta > 1.5.

CELH (+\$526 combined): Clean dual-strike execution. Both the \$43 and \$45 strikes captured 24-28% of premium in one day. Selling at two strikes diversified within the same name.

DELL (+\$987): Week's best CSP trade. Earnings play that expired worthless on 27 Feb for full premium capture. DELL closed at ~\$147.59 vs \$114 strike. Perfect setup, perfect outcome.

NFLX \$80P (+\$414): Solid 42.6% premium capture in one day during market weakness. Deep OTM strike selection showed good risk management.

NVCR (-\$1,334): Largest single loss across both weeks. 14 contracts on a \$13 biotech with \$0.84 premium. Stock moved sharply against, premium expanded to \$1.78 (+112%). This single trade wiped out CELH and NFLX \$80P gains entirely. Lesson: Max 8-10 contracts on sub-\$20 stocks. Cut at 100% premium expansion.

NFLX \$83P (+\$799): Excellent 80.1% premium capture in one day. Entered during NFLX selloff, exited on recovery. Classic fear-to-relief trade.

STRATEGY 2: LONG CALLS

#	Ticker	Entry	Days	Buy\$	Sell\$	Cts	P&L	Return
31	NFLX \$140C	26/02	0.1	\$0.19	\$0.12	39	-\$324	-43.7%

Analysis: Far-OTM speculative call on NFLX. 39 contracts at \$0.19 = \$741 total cost, plus \$50.70 in commissions (6.8% drag). Closed same day at \$0.12 for -\$324 loss. The commission-to-position ratio makes this structure inefficient. Consider fewer contracts at higher-probability strikes for directional bets.

STRATEGY 3: CALENDAR SPREADS

NFLX \$90 CALL CALENDAR SPREAD (Completed)

Leg	Action	Date	Detail	Amount
Open	BOT Calendar	26/02	Long Aug 90C / Short May 90C @ \$11.80	-\$1,180
Close	SOLD Aug 90C	27/02	Aug 26 \$90 Call @ \$12.30	+\$1,230
Close	SOLD May 90C	27/02	May 26 \$90 Call @ \$8.90	+\$890
	NET P&L		(\$1,230 + \$890) - \$1,180 - \$2.60 comm	+\$937

Analysis: This was the week's best trade and a significant milestone. Bought the calendar spread for \$1,180, then unwound both legs the next day for a combined \$2,120 - a \$937 profit (79.4% return in 1 day). The Aug leg appreciated from the spread price while the short May leg could be bought back cheaply once sold. This trade demonstrates that multi-leg strategies can generate outsized returns with defined risk.

Why it worked: NFLX IV shifted between the two expiry dates overnight, creating a profitable spread expansion. The longer-dated Aug call gained value while the shorter May call's time decay worked in your favour. Calendar spreads exploit term structure differences - this is the next evolution of your trading.

GAP \$26 PUT CALENDAR SPREAD (Open)

Detail	Value
Structure	Short 10x Mar13 \$26P / Long 10x Mar6 \$26P
Opened	27/02/2026
Net Credit	\$1,980 (\$1,967 after commissions)
Thesis	GAP earnings play - time decay differential between weekly expiries
Max Risk	Defined by spread structure
Status	OPEN - P&L: +\$25 as of close 27/02

OPEN POSITIONS & PORTFOLIO CONTEXT

ACTIVE POSITIONS (as of 27/02 close)

Position	Dir	Cts	Cost Basis	Mark	P/L Open	Status
GAP Mar13/Mar6 \$26P Spread	Short	10	\$1,980 cr	\$28.04	+\$25	New this week
GOOGL 20 Mar \$340 Call	Long	20	\$33,100	\$1.275	-\$30,550	Essentially dead

Position	Dir	Cts	Cost Basis	Mark	P/L Open	Status
GOOGL 17 Apr \$350 Call	Long	10	\$18,700	\$3.02	-\$15,680	Essentially dead
GOOGL 20 Mar \$350 Call	Long	10	\$12,300	\$0.62	-\$11,680	Essentially dead

GOOGL POSITION ASSESSMENT

Total GOOGL Unrealized Loss: -\$57,910 across three long call positions. GOOGL is trading at ~\$310.55 with the lowest strike at \$340. The Mar 20 expiry options (21 days out) would need GOOGL to rally ~10% just to reach the \$340 strike. At marks of \$1.275 and \$0.62, these are deep OTM with negligible delta. The Apr 17 \$350 calls have slightly more time but still require a massive move. As James notes, these are essentially dead.

Impact on Account: These positions represent \$64,100 in original cost basis against a \$52,207 net liq account. The -\$57,910 unrealized loss is the dominant drag on account equity. Remaining mark value is approximately \$6,190 across all three positions.

Decision Framework: With Mar 20 expiry 21 days away, the \$340 and \$350 Mar calls will likely expire worthless unless a major catalyst emerges. The Apr \$350 calls have 49 days - marginal hope but still deep OTM. Consider whether to let Mar positions expire vs closing early to free up buying power.

ACCOUNT SUMMARY

Metric	Value
Net Liquidation Value	\$52,207.34
Available Cash	\$33,181.34
Buying Power	\$33,181.34
P/L Day (27/02)	+\$1,280.00
GOOGL Unrealized Loss	-\$57,910
Realized P&L (Week 2)	+\$435
Realized P&L (Cumulative, Feb 9-27)	+\$2,193

RISK ANALYSIS

CAPITAL AT RISK BY TRADE

Trade	Capital at Risk	P&L	Return on Risk	Risk Assessment
NU \$16.50P (30 cts)	\$49,500	-\$939	-1.90%	OVERSIZED
RKLB \$67P (6 cts)	\$40,200	-\$632	-1.57%	Weekend risk
CELH \$43P (12 cts)	\$51,600	+\$248	+0.48%	OK
CELH \$45P (7 cts)	\$31,500	+\$278	+0.88%	OK
DELL \$114P (5 cts)	\$57,000	+\$987	+1.73%	Clean
NFLX \$80P (5 cts)	\$40,000	+\$414	+1.03%	Clean
NVCR \$13P (14 cts)	\$18,200	-\$1,334	-7.33%	OVERSIZED
NFLX \$83P (4 cts)	\$33,200	+\$799	+2.41%	Clean
NFLX \$140C (39 cts)	\$741	-\$324	-43.7%	Spec / High comm
NFLX Calendar	\$1,180	+\$937	+79.4%	Excellent

Key Risk Observations:

Two trades flagged as OVERSIZED: NU (30 contracts, \$49,500 at risk) and NVCR (14 contracts on a \$13 stock). Together these lost \$2,273 and represent the difference between a profitable and losing week. The 2% max risk rule (\$52k account = ~\$1,040 max risk per trade) was breached by several CSP positions when measured by assignment risk. While CSP assignment risk is notional, the actual losses show that concentration in high-contract positions is the primary risk factor.

MARKET CONTEXT

VIX REGIME TRANSITION

VIX Range	Classification	Week 1	Week 2	Impact
< 12	Low Volatility			
12-18	Normal		Entering	Premium compression
18-25	Elevated	Current	Exiting	Reduced opportunities
25-35	High			
> 35	Crisis			

VIX This Week: Dropped from ~19.6 to close at 17.93 on 26/02, then spiked to ~20.4 intraday on 27/02. The trend is clearly downward toward the normal range (12-18). This is the regime shift the Week 1 report warned about.

PERFORMANCE VS FORECAST

Metric	Week 1 Report Forecast	Week 2 Actual	Accuracy
Avg CSP Return (win)	15-25% in normal vol	46.7% (still elevated)	Transitioning
Win Rate	70-80%	62.5%	Below forecast
Hold Time	2-3 days	1.6 days	On track
Profit per Day	\$150-250	-\$22 (CSP)	Below - losses dominated

The Week 1 forecasts for a normalizing environment were directionally correct but the transition is messier than predicted. Winners are still returning elevated premiums (46.7% avg), but the increased number of losses pulled overall P&L; negative on CSPs. This is typical of regime transitions.

LESSONS LEARNED

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ NFLX calendar spread: +\$937 in 1 day. Multi-leg strategies work and diversify revenue streams
- ✓ DELL expiry: Full premium capture on an earnings play. Patience and strike selection rewarded
- ✓ NFLX CSPs: Both \$80P and \$83P showed 42-80% premium capture in 1 day on fear-to-relief trades
- ✓ CELH dual-strike: Diversifying within a single name at two strikes reduces concentration risk
- ✓ Quick loss recognition on NFLX \$140C: Cut the speculative long call same day, limited damage

WHAT NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

- **1. Position Sizing - Critical Issue:** Three trades (NU 30 cts, NVCR 14 cts, CELH 12 cts) had contract counts that amplified losses. NU at 30 contracts was \$49,500 in assignment risk against a \$52k account. Rule: Cap CSP contracts so that assignment risk never exceeds 5% of account on any single position (~\$2,600).
 - **2. Loss Management - Stop Loss Needed:** NVCR premium expanded from \$0.84 to \$1.78 (112% against). NU expanded from \$0.38 to \$0.68 (79% against). Both should have been cut earlier. Implement hard rule: Close any CSP where buy-back cost exceeds 2x entry premium.
 - **3. Weekend/Multi-Day Holds:** RCLB held over weekend (4 days) and NU held 6 days - both losses. In a declining-vol environment, extended holds increase gap risk without proportional premium benefit. Rule: Max 2-day hold in transitional vol; avoid Friday-to-Monday on beta > 1.5 names.
 - **4. Commission Efficiency:** NFLX \$140C cost \$50.70 in commissions on a \$741 position (6.8% drag). 39 contracts of a \$0.19 option is commission-heavy. For spec trades, use fewer contracts at higher strikes.
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STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS (Next 1-2 Weeks)

1. Implement Position Sizing Rules

- Max assignment risk per CSP: 5% of account (~\$2,600 on \$52k account)
- Max 10 contracts on sub-\$20 stocks, max 5 on sub-\$50 stocks
- Scale contract count inversely with strike price

2. Implement Hard Stop Loss

- Close any CSP where buy-back cost exceeds 2x entry premium
- Set alerts in TOS at 1.5x premium as early warning

3. Increase Calendar Spread Allocation

- NFLX calendar was the week's best trade (+79.4%) with defined risk (\$1,180)
- Aim for 2-3 calendar/spread trades per week alongside CSPs
- Focus on names with liquid options and term structure opportunities (NFLX, AMZN, TSLA)

4. GOOGL Decision Point

- Mar 20 calls (\$340 and \$350 strikes): 21 days to expiry, GOOGL at \$310. Consider closing for residual value vs letting expire
- Apr 17 \$350 calls: 49 days, slightly more optionality. Decide threshold for closing
- Any recovered capital can be redeployed into higher-probability strategies

VIX-REGIME PLAYBOOK (Updated)

VIX	Primary Strategy	Position Count	Target Return	Max Hold	Contract Cap
< 12	Iron condors / Reduce	2-3/week	10-15%	3-5 days	Conservative
12-18	CSPs + Calendars	3-5/week	15-25%	2-3 days	Moderate
18-25	Aggressive CSPs	5-8/week	30-50%	0-2 days	Standard
> 25	Wait / Small only	0-2/week	Variable	Intraday	Minimal

WEEKLY PERFORMANCE TRACKER

Week	Period	Trades	Win Rate	CSP P&L	Other P&L	Total P&L	Cumulative
1	Feb 9-19	10	80.0%	+\$1,758	\$0	+\$1,758	+\$1,758
2	Feb 20-27	10	60.0%	-\$179	+\$614	+\$435	+\$2,193
3	Feb 28-Mar 6	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	Mar 7-13	-	-	-	-	-	-

CONCLUSION

Performance Assessment: A pivotal learning week. The +\$435 total P&L; was rescued by the NFLX calendar spread and DELL expiry - without those two trades, CSPs alone would have been -\$179. This highlights both the risk of relying on a single strategy and the value of diversification you're building.

The Real Story: This week tested something more important than P&L;; your ability to adapt when conditions change. CSP returns compressed, losses got bigger, and the easy money from Week 1's vol spike is fading. Your response was to execute a calendar spread that generated +\$937, try a speculative long call (lesson learned), and open a GAP put calendar. That's the right instinct. The trader who survives regime changes is the one who has multiple tools.

Critical Focus: Position sizing and loss management are the two things standing between you and consistent profitability. The NVCR and NU losses were both predictable and preventable with tighter rules. Fix those two things and this week's P&L; would have been +\$2,000+.

Next Report: Friday, March 6, 2026